



Missing identities, skewed history, compatibility issues, dying music, disappearing arrows—the doctor will see you now...

A failing hard disk

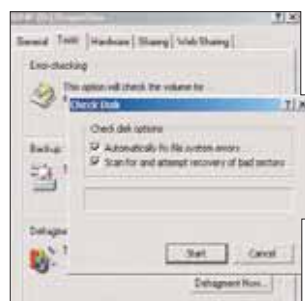
Q I've been facing a strange problem lately. Windows shows an error message about the name and location of files and folders that I know are there on the hard disk—I've been working with these files till recently. Is my hard disk about to crash?

Rama

Via e-mail

A It could simply mean that a rogue software has scrambled your data or that it is an isolated hardware glitch.

Run ScanDisk and set it to examine the entire disk for physically damaged sectors. If you're using Windows 98 or Me, click **Start > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > ScanDisk** and enable the Thorough option. In Windows 2000 and XP, open



Let ScanDisk automatically correct all errors it encounters

My Computer, right-click the drive, select **Properties > Tools** and click the Check Now button under Error-checking. Next, check 'Automatically fix file system errors' and 'Scan for and attempt to fix bad sectors'.

If ScanDisk reports only a few logical

errors, such as cross-linked or fragmented files, let ScanDisk repair the files. But if it reports more than a few physical errors, it's time to immediately back up your data. It is a good practice to run ScanDisk once a month to catch hard disk problems in time. Also, try using Search to locate the files in case they've been moved accidentally. Run an anti-virus program to eliminate the possibility of the filenames being changed due to a viral attack.

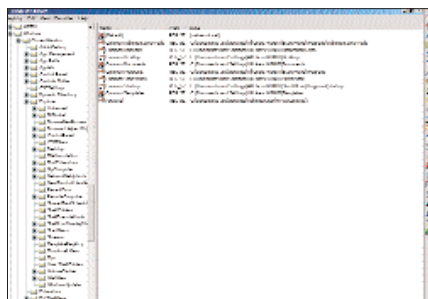
Double trouble

Q I am facing a peculiar problem with Windows 2000 Server. The programs in the Startup folder or the All Users Startup folder starts twice, slowing down my startup.

Rita Joshi

Via e-mail

A The likely reason for this is that the registry entries for the two Startup folders are pointing to the same place. The All Users Startup folder is usually located in



The Registry Editor is a very powerful tool for modifying Windows settings

C:\Documents and Settings\All Users\Start Menu\Programs\Startup. The user-specific Startup folder is the same except that the username replaces 'All users'. Verify these locations in Windows Explorer. Open the registry (go to **Start > Run** and type **regedit**) and browse to the following keys: HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Shell folders, HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\User Shell Folders, HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Shell folders, HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\User Shell Folders.

For each key, examine the right-hand pane for values named Startup or Common Startup. The All Users Startup can be correctly identified as %ALLUSERSPROFILE%\Start menu\programs\Startup, and the user-specific startup as %USER-PROFILES%\Start Menu\Programs\Startup. Double-click to fix the ones that point to the wrong folder.

Error reporting gets irritating

Q If any of my programs causes a fatal error, Windows XP doesn't force me to reboot, but it keeps asking me if I want to send a report to Microsoft, which is quite annoying. Is there some way I can stop this?

Natasha

Via e-mail